



Inspection Report

Yerrington Empire
1008 Morningside Drive
Andrews, TX 79714

Customer ID: **6020468**
Certificate: **74-B-0833**
Site: 002
Yerrington Empire

Type: FOCUSED INSPECTION
Date: 02-SEP-2026

2.131(c)(1)

Handling of animals.

The facility exhibits animals in a manner that does not pose minimal risk of harm to the animals and members of the public. The inspector witnessed a boy and teenaged girl each participate in separate full-contact sessions inside an enclosure with one approximately 5-month-old male ring-tailed lemur and one approximately 4-month-old female ring-tailed lemur. The only employee of the store remained outside the enclosure, unable to reach the animal without opening the door. The animals freely jumped onto the arms, shoulders and heads of the children, at times pressing their faces very close and even touching the heads and faces of the children. The girl jerked her head back a few times in response to a lemur touching her face-to-face and the boy was seen turning his face away as a lemur touched the boy's head and face while it sat on his shoulder. The inspector spoke to the licensee by phone directly after the encounters, and the licensee told the inspector that the store would no longer offer these contact encounters.

Allowing animals to climb on the heads, necks, and shoulders of the public and make facial contact is not a method of handling that promotes minimal risk to the public and to the animal. Such interactions pose a threat of zoonotic disease transmission and can lead to injury of the animals and/or the public if the animal becomes afraid or surprised. The licensee must ensure that during public exhibition, any animal must be handled so there is minimal risk of harm to the animal and to the public, with sufficient distance and/or barriers between the animal and the general viewing public to assure the safety of animals and the public.

CORRECTED AT THE TIME OF THIS INSPECTION ON 09/02/2026

2.131(d)(2)

Handling of animals.

During a paid, full-contact animal encounter between the public and two, young ring-tailed lemurs, the only store employee present asked the inspector if she (the store employee) could leave to give fresh water to other animals in the store. In response, the inspector said that the employee should not leave during the encounters and asked if direct public contact is allowed without supervision of a store employee. The store employee replied that she sometimes has to step away to help other customers for no more than two minutes when she is the only one working, and that she asks the encounter participants to call out for her if anything seems to be going wrong. The inspector spoke to the licensee by phone directly after the encounters, and the licensee told the inspector that the store would no longer offer these contact encounters.

Lack of employee oversight during direct interactions between the animals and the public may lead to injury to people

Prepared By: TAMILA STOTT

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:
02-SEP-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Received by Title: Licensee

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and/or injury or distress to the animals. A responsible, knowledgeable, and readily identifiable employee or attendant must be present at all times during periods of public contact.

CORRECTED AT THE TIME OF THIS INSPECTION ON 09/02/2026

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with a facility representative and the licensee.

Prepared By: TAMILA STOTT
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
6020468	74-B-0833	002	Yerrington Empire	02-SEP-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000002	<i>Lemur catta</i>	RING-TAILED LEMUR
000002	Total	